



Orazio Pontorno

AI RESEARCHER
opontorno.github.io

🇮🇹 Italian
📅 13 Oct 1999, Palermo

CONTACT

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RESEARCH AREAS

- Computer Vision
- Image Processing
- AIGC Detection
- Generative Models
- Applied Mathematics
- Multimedia
- Media Forensics
- Graph Learning
- Anomaly Detection

TOOLS & TECH

- Languages
- Python
- R
- SQL
- MATLAB
- ML & DL
- PyTorch
- scikit-learn
- NumPy
- pandas
- MLflow
- Data & Cloud
- PySpark
- Databricks
- Amazon SageMaker
- MySQL
- Workflow
- Git
- LaTeX
- Docker
- Tableau

LANGUAGES

Italian Native
English B2

INTERESTS

♟ Chess · 🏋 Fitness · ✈ Travel

ABOUT

Final-year PhD researcher in Artificial Intelligence with a solid theoretical foundation in Applied Mathematics, holding a Master’s in Data Science and a Bachelor’s in Mathematics. Specializes in theoretical and methodological advancements within Computer Vision, Image Processing, Synthetic Media Forensics, and AIGC Detection. Experienced in conducting cutting-edge scientific research across international academic institutions and corporate R&D environments.

EXPERIENCE

■ Jan 2026 – Jun 2026

Visiting Researcher

SUNY Polytechnic Institute · Utica, NY, USA · On-site · Full-time

Deepfake analysis and detection in medical imaging.
Medical Image Analysis · AIGC Detection · Computer Vision · Generative Models · Image Processing

■ Mar 2025 – Dec 2025

AI Researcher

Life360 · San Mateo, CA, USA · Remote · Full-time

ML models for personalized ad targeting and causal inference in recommendation systems.
Causal Inference · Similarity Models · Databricks · Amazon SageMaker AI · PySpark

■ Apr 2024 – Feb 2025

R&D Data Scientist

Fantix Inc. · Milan, Italy · Hybrid · Contract

Data enrichment models based on graph and hypergraph representations.
Graph Neural Networks · Hypergraph Models · Amazon SageMaker AI · PyTorch · Deep Learning

■ Apr 2023 – Jun 2023

Student Research Assistant

iCTLab s.r.l. · Catania, Italy · Hybrid · Internship

Deep learning models for synthetic media forensics and deepfake detection.
Multimedia · Deepfake Detection · Generative Models · Image Processing · Deep Learning

■ Feb 2023 – Aug 2023

Research Assistant

Vicosistems s.r.l. · Catania, Italy · Hybrid · Scholarship

GAN-based anomaly detection on time-series data for predictive maintenance.
Anomaly Detection · Time-series · Predictive Maintenance · GAN-networks · Deep Learning

EDUCATION

■ Nov 2023 – present

PhD in Artificial Intelligence – XXXIX Cycle

Università Campus Bio-Medico of Roma · University of Catania

■ Oct 2021 – Sep 2023

Master’s Degree in Data Science

University of Catania

Grade: 110/110 summa cum laude
Thesis: *An AI Forensics approach for the recognition of synthetic image-generating architecture based on diffusion models*

■ Sep 2022 – Nov 2022

Postgraduate Course – AI: Deep Learning, Vision & Language

Università degli Studi di Modena e Reggio Emilia

■ Sep 2018 – Dec 2021

Bachelor’s Degree in Mathematics

University of Catania

Grade: 105/110
Thesis: *Teoria dei Codici: Codici Lineari*

SELECTED PUBLICATIONS

■ 2026

μFlow: Leveraging Average Images for Improving Generalisation of Deepfake Faces Detectors

Accepted at European Conference on Computer Vision (ECCV) 2026

O. Pontorno*, M. Litrico*, L. Guanera, V. Giuffrida, S. Battiato
🔗 Project page: opontorno.github.io/MuFlow

■ 2026

HexMIL: Hierarchical Attention MIL for Ante-Hoc Explainable Detection of AI-Manipulated CT Volumes

Accepted at 34th ACM International Conference on Multimedia

O. Pontorno, L. Guanera, Z. Akhtar, S. Battiato

🔗 Project page: opontorno.github.io/hexmil

■ 2025

DeepFeatureX-SN: Generalization of deepfake detection via contrastive learning
Multimedia Tools and Application

O. Pontorno, L. Guanera, S. Battiato

🔗 doi: [10.1007/s11042-025-21060-1](https://doi.org/10.1007/s11042-025-21060-1)

■ 2024

On the exploitation of DCT-traces in the generative-AI domain
IEEE International Conference on Image Processing (ICIP)

O. Pontorno, L. Guanera, S. Battiato

🔗 doi: [10.1109/ICIP51287.2024.10648013](https://doi.org/10.1109/ICIP51287.2024.10648013)

Catania, 8th August 2026


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